

ML Paper — Journal Target List

Cost-Aware Alpha Generation with FDR Control and Market-Impact-Aware Validation

Data: yfinance + Kaggle SPY + Ken French + FRED (all free, Scopus-acceptable)
Target: High IF · Scopus Q1 · Applied ML or Finance

Tier 1 — Submit Now (in parallel)

Priority	Journal	Publisher	IF	Scopus	Format
#1	Expert Systems with Applications	Elsevier	10.48	Q1	Full ~30 pp
#2	Finance Research Letters	Elsevier	7.4	Q1	Short 3 500 words

#1 ESA — Primary target. yfinance data accepted routinely. ML pipeline contributions (FDR + PBO + Almgren-Chriss + conformal CP) are core scope. Highest viable IF given data constraints.

#2 FRL — Run *in parallel* with #1. Single finding: “*Track B OOS net Sharpe +0.50 after joint FDR control and market-impact adjustment.*” Turnaround 6–8 weeks; gets the OOS result into the literature while ESA review runs (~3–4 months).

Tier 2 — Fallback if Tier 1 Rejects

Priority	Journal	Publisher	IF	Scopus
#3	Knowledge-Based Systems	Elsevier	7.6	Q1
#4	Information Sciences	Elsevier	8.1	Q1
#5	Decision Support Systems	Elsevier	7.5	Q1
#6	Applied Soft Computing	Elsevier	7.2	Q1

#3 ESA sibling; same data bar, slightly lower IF. **#4** Broad ML applications; large readership; yfinance fine. **#5** Reframe as “uncertainty-aware capital allocation framework.” **#6** Ensemble methods + applied ML angle.

Tier 3 — Finance-Audience Journals

Priority	Journal	Publisher	IF	Scopus
#7	Quantitative Finance	Taylor & Francis	2.6	Q1
#8	Journal of Portfolio Management	Pageant Media	2.0	Q1

#7: Reviewers understand FDR / PBO / AC costs without explanation. **#8:** Practitioner audience; OOS result + cost surface = PM reading material. Lower IF but the paper is best *understood* here.

Do Not Target

Journal	Reason
RFS / JoF / JFE	CRSP required — blocked without WRDS / university affiliation
TNNLS / TPAMI	No neural network content — desk reject
ICML / NeurIPS / ICLR	No new ML algorithm — desk reject
Int. Journal of Forecasting	Comparable paper (Wolff & Echterling 2024) used Bloomberg; yfinance borderline
Neural Networks (Elsevier)	No neural network models in paper

Submission Timeline

When	Action
Week 1–2	Expand paper: 8 IEEE pages → 30 manuscript pages Add: ablation study, extended related work, baseline comparisons
Week 2	Submit full paper to ESA (mc.manuscriptcentral.com/eswa)
Week 2	Submit 3 500-word letter to FRL (in parallel)
Month 3	ESA decision → accept or route to KBS / Information Sciences

What the ESA Expansion Needs

1. **Extended related work** — GKX2020, Wolff & Echterling (2024), Harvey et al. (2016)
2. **Ablation study** — net Sharpe with / without: FDR filter, conformal sizing, ADV filter
3. **Baseline table** — buy-and-hold, equal-weight momentum, gross-only benchmark
4. **Limitations section** — yfinance data quality, SPY constituent approximation, S&P 500 universe only

Key Results (Reference)

Metric	Track A (Reversal)	Track B (Macro/Sector)
BH-significant features	16	25
PBO (126 CSCV paths)	0.00	0.14
IS gross Sharpe (2013–21)	+0.496	−0.192
IS net Sharpe (weekly, 3 bps)	−0.095	−0.665
OOS gross Sharpe (2022–24)	−0.346	+0.705
OOS net Sharpe (2022–24)	−0.584	+0.501
Conformal coverage (target 90%)	88.8%	89.1%